

Steppe — Schedule of Defaults

Document: Schedule of Defaults (member-governed community norms) **Version:** Working Draft v0.1 **Status:** DRAFT — not yet ratified. Initial defaults to be confirmed by the founding cohort and reviewed by counsel. **Canonical repo path (suggested):** docs/Steppe-Schedule-of-Defaults-v0.1.md **Governing instruments:** Governance Charter & Bylaws (Article V, Article III); Terms of Membership §2 (two-tier model); Trust & Safety / Verification decision record §3. **Last updated:** 2026-07-08

What this is. This Schedule holds the **community norms** — the layer of “what is and isn’t allowed on Steppe” that the members govern. It is the amendable companion to the **non-votable legal floor** in Terms of Membership §2. Members set, and may change, everything in this Schedule through the governance process; members do **not** get to vote the legal floor away.

Amendment. Unless a specific item states otherwise, this Schedule is amended by **Major Policy vote** (60% of votes cast, quorum met) under Charter Article V. Any item that would touch an Entrenched Commitment (Charter Article III) requires a **Foundational Decision** (75% + 30-day notice) instead. Changes are versioned and recorded in the governance log.

Not legal advice; draft. Bracketed items are decisions for the founding cohort. This draft is written to be clear and enforceable and is pending counsel review.

0. How to read this Schedule

- **The legal floor comes first and is not here.** Conduct on the non-votable legal floor — illegal goods/services, CSAM, non-consensual intimate imagery, credible threats of violence, human trafficking or exploitation — is prohibited everywhere on Steppe regardless of anything in this Schedule, and is defined in Terms of Membership §2. This Schedule never overrides, narrows, or re-enables anything on that floor.
- **Everything in this Schedule is member-governed.** It can be proposed, debated, and changed by members under Charter Article V. If a norm here ever conflicts with the Charter or the legal floor, the Charter and the floor control.
- **Enforcement is separate from the rules.** *What* is allowed lives here; *how* violations are handled (reactive, report-driven, human-decided, appealable) lives in Terms of Membership §3 and the moderation process. This Schedule sets the norms; it does not change the due-process guarantees.

1. Community conduct norms

Members agree to treat neighbors as neighbors. The following are the baseline community norms; members may refine them by vote.

1.1 Civility and good faith. Engage others in good faith. Disagreement, criticism, and robust debate are welcome; personal attacks, demeaning treatment, and bad-faith disruption are not.

1.2 Harassment. No harassment — including targeted insults, repeated unwanted contact, pile-ons, or intimidation of another member. Harassment is judged by its effect on a reasonable neigh-

bor, not only by the intent of the person doing it.

1.3 Hate and dehumanization. No content that attacks or dehumanizes people on the basis of who they are (for example race, ethnicity, national origin, religion, disability, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, or age). *[Cohort to confirm the protected-characteristic list and align it with Oregon law.]*

1.4 Privacy of neighbors. No sharing of another person's private information without consent (doxxing), and no impersonation of another member, official, or organization.

1.5 Honesty about who you are. One account per member. Do not misrepresent your residency, create fake or duplicate accounts, or evade verification or moderation.

1.6 Spam and manipulation. No spam, mass unsolicited messaging, vote manipulation, or coordinated inauthentic behavior. Surfacing and sorting on Steppe are chronological/proximity-based by design; do not attempt to game ranking or flood proposals.

1.7 Keep it local and human. Steppe is a place for real neighbors. Automated scraping, bulk data extraction, and off-platform commercial harvesting of member content are not permitted.

2. The Exchange (marketplace listings)

Steppe hosts member listings. The Exchange is **listings-only** — Steppe processes, holds, and escrows **no** money, and is not a party to any transaction (Terms §4; Charter canon). Members arrange anything that follows off-platform, at their own arrangement and risk.

2.1 Permitted listing categories *(member-governed; initial defaults)*:

- **Needs** — requests for help, items, or services a neighbor is looking for.
- **Offers** — items or help a neighbor is giving or lending.
- **Goods** — physical items offered to neighbors. *[Cohort to confirm whether for-sale goods are permitted and, if so, how this squares with the “no commercial solicitation” norm in §2.3 — see reconciliation note.]*
- **Jobs** — local, occasional, or community work. *[Same reconciliation note.]*
- **Mutual aid** — no-cost help freely offered or requested.
- **Events** — gatherings, meetings, and neighborhood happenings (see §3).

2.2 Prohibited items and listings *(member-governed; initial defaults, on top of the legal floor)*:

- anything on the legal floor (Terms §2) — always prohibited, never votable back in;
- weapons and ammunition, and controlled substances (including cannabis, notwithstanding Oregon legality) *[cohort to confirm]*;
- live animals *[cohort to confirm]*;
- recalled, counterfeit, or stolen goods;
- adult/sexual services;
- multi-level-marketing recruitment, financial-instrument sales, and get-rich schemes;
- anything requiring a professional license the lister does not hold (for example medical, legal, or financial advice offered as a service).

2.3 Commercial-solicitation norm (reconciliation required). Steppe is not a general advertising marketplace, and broad commercial solicitation is discouraged; commercial *discovery* is intended to live with Steppe's partner, Redmond Compass, not on-platform. **Open item for the cohort and**

counsel: define the exact line between a permitted member Exchange listing (a neighbor offering goods or occasional work) and prohibited commercial solicitation (a business advertising), and state it identically here and in both Terms surfaces. Today the formal Terms permit “goods” and “jobs” listings while the consent-gate Terms bar commercial soliciting — this Schedule is the right home for the settled rule, once decided.

2.4 Reporting. Any member may report a listing; moderators act on reports under Terms §3. Verified residency is the primary deterrent against bad-faith dealing.

3. Groups and events

3.1 Member-run. Groups, neighborhood events, gatherings, and mutual-aid activity are created and run by members, not by Steppe. Steppe verifies residency but does not otherwise vet members and is not a party to what members arrange. Meet safely and use good judgment.

3.2 Group norms. A group may adopt its own additional norms so long as they sit **above** these community defaults and the legal floor — a group may be stricter, never more permissive than the floor. Group maintainers apply group norms subject to the same report-and-appeal process.

3.3 Events. Event listings must be accurate as to time, place, and host. Events may not be used to route around the prohibited-items list or the legal floor. *[Cohort/counsel to confirm any safety, insurance, or waiver expectations for in-person gatherings — see the liability note in the review annex.]*

4. Content norms

4.1 Ownership and license. Members keep ownership of what they post; Steppe holds only the limited license needed to store and display content to operate the service (Terms §5). Content norms never transfer ownership or permit advertising, profiling, or sale.

4.2 No images on community content, by default. Consistent with Steppe’s privacy-by-architecture posture, general community content is text-first. *[Cohort to confirm the scope of the “no-images” default and its exceptions; note that verification evidence is expressly exempt and is deleted immediately upon a verification decision.]*

4.3 Minors. Steppe is an adults-only (18+) platform at this time; content directed at or soliciting minors is prohibited. A future 13-17 version, if built, will carry its own protections and its own norms adopted by member vote.

5. Relationship to enforcement and appeals

Nothing in this Schedule changes the moderation guarantees: enforcement is reactive and report-driven, a human (never an automated system) makes every consequential decision, outcomes are recorded in the public transparency log, and any action can be appealed through the governance process (Terms §3; Charter Article IV.7). Automation may surface or sort reports; it never decides.

6. Amendment log

Version	Date	Change	Process
v0.1 (draft)	2026-07-08	Initial draft created to fill the reference gap (cited in the decision record and /legal/terms but not previously written). Not yet ratified.	Pending founding-cohort ratification

Initial defaults marked “[cohort to confirm]” are placeholders for the founding membership to set through the first governance cycle. Once ratified, this Schedule is amendable by Major Policy vote (60%, quorum met) except where an item touches an Entrenched Commitment.